killings in Punjab, including those of 24 people who were attending a Majlis in Mominpura. He also revealed that his group had planned to kill Interior Minister Moinuddin Hiader, but due to tight security, murdered his brother instead. After the death of Riaz Basra, Akram Lahori became acting chief of LeJ. It is believed that he himself supervised and perpetrated the sectarian target killing in the city of Karachi – bastion for his outlawed organisation.

Lahori's predecessor Riaz Basra was involved in more than 300 terrorist incidents, including attacking Iranian missions, killing an Iranian diplomat Sadiq Ganji in December 1990 and targeting government officials. He was arrested and tried by a special court for Ganji's killing (Iranian consulate); however, he escaped during the trial in 1994 from police custody while being produced in court. He was Chief of the Khalid bin Walid unit of the Afghan Mujahideen in Afghanistan. According to media reports, Riaz Basra and three of his accomplices were killed in an encounter on 14 May 2002.

Before the news of Riaz Basra's killing spread, it was reported that he was arrested after a tip off from one of the activist of his groups, Ajmal alia Sheikh Jamshaid in Faisalabad. He helped the police in arresting another important member of LeJ, Liaqat Ali, and also gave information to the police to arrest Basra after carrying out several raids in different parts of the country, including Faisalabad, Jhang, Sargodha and Lahore.

Riaz Basra was ranked high among the sectarian terrorists and had been considered a radical religious fanatic. He was a very active and motivated member of the parent organisation of LeJ, Sipah I Sahaba Pakistan. He also took part in political activities. As a member of Sipah-e-Sahaba, he also contested elections for provincial assembly in 1988. Under his leadership and influence, LeJ became one of the most deadly and most radical sectarian militant organisations. He even threatened the top political leadership of Pakistan, including the then Prime Minister Mian Muhammad Nawaz Sharif, who had even stopped attending open courts fearing the threat. The majority of the top and mid-level leadership of LeJ consists of militants who fought in Afghanistan or Kashmir. They became an important part of the LeJ cadre. The majority of its activists were from the Deobandi (Sunni) madrasahs spread all across Pakistan, although their major support bases were urban centres.